

Rongrong GAO

AI PhD AND RESEARCHER, HKUST

OBJECTIVE

I have joined **SenseTime** in 2017 and **Allybot** in 2018, respectively, where I have been working on AI research and device-level development in *intelligent AI systems* and *autonomous driving and robotics perception systems*. From 2019 to 2024, I continued my Ph.D. career at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (**HKUST**), focusing on AI-related research in *3D Vision*, *multi-modal AI* and *GenAI* applications.
Adept at general AI, I am now eager to seek a challenging engineering position to contribute my expertise and drive organizational success.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Computer Science and Engineering *Sep' 2019 - Oct' 2024*
Dep. of CSE, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong
Major in 3D robotics perception systems and GenAI, under the supervision of Prof. **Qifeng Chen**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GenAI and 3D representations - AI Startup, UAE *Nov' 2024 - Present*
Developed a real-time multi-modal-to-3D generation system that converts user inputs from multiple modalities into high-fidelity 3D representations on embedded, low-latency hardware platforms.
Designed and optimized efficient 3D reconstruction and generation pipelines for resource-constrained edge devices. Leveraged generative AI and 3D representation learning to support digital content ownership protection and commercialization for artists and creators.

AI perception systems for robotics - HKUST, Hong Kong *Sep' 2019 - Oct' 2024*
Watermarking for Generative Foundation Models

- Proposed a novel training-data copyright protection framework for large-scale generative models.
- Designed differentiable watermark embedding and extraction networks robust to diffusion sampling, model fine-tuning, and common post-processing operations by formulating the task as an information-theoretic optimization problem, enabling imperceptible yet reliable ownership verification.
- Investigated copyright protection mechanisms for foundation models and generative AI systems.

Multi-modal Representation Learning for RGB-D Data

- Developed a cross-modal information hiding framework that embeds depth information into RGB images and reconstructs it with high fidelity.
- Designed a multi-modal feature fusion architecture for joint representation learning by exploiting cross-modality redundancy between RGB and depth data through feature disentanglement and representation learning.
- Addressed challenges in storage, transmission of diverse multi-modal data.

3D Vision, Geometric Learning, and Scene Understanding

- Developed the Semantics-and-Geometry-aware Network (SGNet) for point cloud colorization, jointly modeling geometric structure and semantic context.
- Constructed the ToF-100 dataset and designed a joint depth-normal estimation framework for geometric scene understanding.
- Built an end-to-end sensing-to-learning pipeline integrating data acquisition, annotation, model training, and evaluation for real-world robotic perception applications.

Autonomous driving perception system - Allybot, China *June'2018 - Sep'2019*

- Developed real-time perception algorithms for autonomous driving, including object detection, multi-object tracking, semantic segmentation, and 3D localization of vehicles, pedestrians, and traffic infrastructure.
- Built a large-scale camera-LiDAR dataset and established a complete data pipeline covering collection, annotation, quality control, and dataset construction.
- Designed an image-point cloud fusion framework to improve perception robustness under adverse weather and challenging environmental conditions.
- Architected and integrated the perception software stack with localization, planning, and control modules within the autonomous driving system.
- Optimized and deployed deep learning models using CUDA, TensorRT, and ONNX for real-time on-board inference.
- Collaborated on system validation, code optimization, and software version management, improving reliability and operational stability through both simulation and real-world testing.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS	FIRST and CO-AUTHOR: (* Corresponding author; † equal contributions.) - B Liu, Z Huang, Y Li, R Gao, HX Chen, TZ Xiang. HATFormer: Height-aware Transformer for multi-modal 3D change detection. <i>ISPRS Journal of Photogrammetry and Remote Sensing</i> (ISPRS), 2025. - R Wu, TZ Xiang, GS Xie, R Gao, X Shu, F Zhao, L Shao. Uncertainty-aware transformer for referring camouflaged object detection. <i>IEEE Transactions on Image Processing</i> (TIP),2025. - ZJ Wu, R Gao, TZ Xiang. Scribble-Based Weakly Supervised Camouflaged Object Detection via SAM-Guided Feature Correlation Transformer. <i>European Conference on Artificial Intelligence</i> (ECAI), 2025. - B Dong, J Pei, R Gao, T-Z Xiang*, S Wang, H Xiong. A Unified Query-based Paradigm for Camouflaged Instance Segmentation. <i>ACM International Conference on Multimedia</i> (ACM MM), 2023. - Z Chen, R Gao, T-Z Xiang, F Lin. Diffusion Model for Camouflaged Object Detection. <i>European Conference on Artificial Intelligence</i> (ECAI), 2023. - R Gao, T-Z Xiang, C Lei, J Park, Q Chen. Scene-level Point Cloud Colorization with Semantics-and-geometry-aware Networks. <i>IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation</i> (ICRA), 2023. R Gao, T-Z Xiang, C Lei, J Park, Q Chen. Scene-level Point Cloud Colorization with Semantics-and-geometry-aware Networks. <i>IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation</i> (ICRA), 2023. R Gao, N Fan, C Li, W Liu, Q Chen. Joint depth and normal estimation from real-world time-of-flight raw data. <i>IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems</i> (IROS), 2021. - Y Wu, R Gao, J Park, Q Chen. Future video synthesis with object motion prediction. <i>Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern</i> (CVPR), 2020.	
HONORS & AWARDS	2019–2024 Hong Kong PhD Fellowship Scheme (HKPFS), Top 8% 2016 National Scholarships of China, Wuhan University, Top 1% 2014 Outstanding Graduates, Wuhan University, Top 5% 2013 National Scholarships of China, Wuhan University, Top 5% 2012 National Scholarships of China, Wuhan University, Top 1% 2011 National Scholarships of China, Wuhan University, Top 1%	
COMPUTER SKILLS	Programming Languages: Python, MATLAB, C/C++, $\LaTeX$ Research Tools: PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenCV, Docker Expertise: Computer Vision, Remote Sensing, Photogrammetry, Deep Learning	